

there was a week I didn't sleep
stayed up counting the hours
as the earth turned around me

shook off insomnia with quiet
sobs & late morning showers.
what day is it?

what year? month?
how long has it been since I last
wrote a poem with meaning?

my apartment flooded this
morning & I pulled maggots
from the surface of the carpet,

all wriggling & ill-of-tongue.
it's liveable, he tells me, *better*
to choke down the worms than

continue to dig through mud
for gold. I obey. I scoop them
with both hands

& let them
slide between my teeth & cry.
gag. beg. but still

I swallow & let them
eat me from the inside
out.

I say, *my eyes are*
tired, he says, *sleep*. I
disagree. there are

worms in my lungs.
i can't breath. I tell him,
my hands are dirty.

he says, *wash them*.
I disagree. I am suffocating
on what he is feeding me.

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we are writing an anthology
on ways to hurt one another.

tell me that you love me one
more time , I am in need of
convincing

my poems are bittersweet,
but rotten. beyond what they

used to be I am looking for a
muse that I can no longer get
back.

punch me next time. . . I'm begging.
because a fist to my jaw, leaves
less marks than the broken hearted
questions lingering in my mind.

the desire to be more of anything.
more whole. more spacious. more
less-empty. are you happy now?

are you ready to marry me now,
knowing I am full of lies & maggots
& promises you've made that even
I cannot keep.

I was born from two survivors, it
was only fate that you would be
my hubris.